

C3.ai

Enterprise AI applications for manufacturing, energy, defense and financial services · [c3.ai](#)

2009 Founded	~1,000–1,180 Employees	\$389M (FY2025) Revenue (latest/est.)	Public Ownership	2.9/5 Glassdoor (825)	No Digital twin
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01 Overview

Public but smaller and less differentiated than Palantir, with real recent strain: revenue growth has decelerated sharply, founder Tom Siebel resumed the CEO role in May 2026 after a health-related leadership change, and Glassdoor sentiment has fallen from 3.1 to 2.9 over the past year. Offering: C3 Agentic AI Platform (end-to-end build/deploy/operate environment) plus 40+ prebuilt, industry-specific Enterprise AI applications and C3 Generative AI tools.	Key facts HQ: Redwood City, CA Ownership: Public (NYSE: AI) Revenue: \$389.1M (FY2025), up 25% YoY; quarterly revenue has since decelerated (Q4 FY2026: \$51.6M) Web: c3.ai · LinkedIn Key people: Thomas M. Siebel (Chairman & CEO (resumed role May 2026)) · Stephen Ehikian (President (CEO Sept 2025–May 2026)) · Edward Abbo (Chief Technology Officer) Digital twin: No · GenAI: Yes
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02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Energy (oil & gas)	Shell — predictive maintenance at scale	Scaled AI predictive maintenance to 10,000 pieces of equipment	Link
Energy (JV)	Baker Hughes — industrial asset management JV	6-year, \$495M minimum commitment (through June 2025); Baker Hughes holds an equity stake and a board seat	Link
Chemicals	LyondellBasell — five-year expanded enterprise AI contract	Contract expansion signed to accelerate enterprise AI deployment across operations	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Sand Technologies · Palantir Technologies · Cognite · Bentley Systems · AVEVA · IBM watsonx · Honeywell Forge · Siemens Xcelerator Where it sits: Closest comparable to Sand on “vertical AI applications” positioning, but sells software licenses/subscriptions rather than the services-heavy delivery model Sand uses — and is currently the most stressed name on this list financially and organizationally.
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04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock’s dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.	
Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No connection found. None of C3.ai’s named customers (Shell, Baker Hughes, Bank of America, U.S. Air Force/Army, Cargill, Koch) are GIP portfolio companies.
BlackRock	Confirmed passive ownership — 6.8% of shares outstanding per BlackRock’s April 2026 Schedule 13G/A filing, its largest disclosed institutional holder after Vanguard (6.1%) and founder Thomas Siebel’s combined family/trust stakes (~15%+).

05 Sentiment

Customer: Public case studies (Shell, Baker Hughes, LyondellBasell) show real deployed scale, but G2/Gartner Peer Insights review volume is modest for a public company of this size, and the JV-heavy customer base makes independent reference-checking harder than for a typical SaaS vendor.	
What supports the story • Broad partner ecosystem — six-year Microsoft Azure partnership, plus AWS and Google Cloud alliances • Federal/defense bookings grew 134% YoY in a recent quarter as government AI demand accelerates • 40+ prebuilt industry applications shorten deployment time versus building from scratch	What to pressure-test • Customer concentration risk: Baker Hughes has historically been ~20–30% of revenue via a JV with renegotiated minimums • Quarterly revenue has decelerated markedly (Q3 FY2025 from \$98.8M in Q3 FY2025 to \$51.6M in Q4 FY2026, per filings) • Founder Tom Siebel stepped back for health reasons in Sept 2025, then resumed the CEO role in May 2026 — real leadership turbulence • One recent employee review (unverified, anecdotal) described revenue “plummeting” and headcount falling sharply — directionally consistent with the filed revenue deceleration but not independently confirmed at that magnitude

Employee: Recent reviews cite a sharp deterioration — “sinking ship” language and reports of aggressive attrition — a marked reversal from C3.ai’s earlier “highest-rated cloud company to work for” recognition (Battery Ventures/Glassdoor, ~2021).

Sources: C3.ai public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked “est.” or “not disclosed” are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.